Cover letter

Dear PLOS ONE Editorial Office,

Please advise on consideration of the substantially revised Research Article, **“Source-cohort expansion improves weaker-class coverage in cross-subject motor-imagery EEG decoding.”**

The study evaluates a practical data-design strategy: expanding the source acquisition cohort while holding the full neural-trajectory update budget fixed. A common 18-channel processing contract, source-only checkpoint selection and equal-duration controls support an external comparison in 85 participants. Relative to the nine-person source pool, the 60-person configuration improved weaker-class recall by 21.17 percentage points (95% CI 17.12–25.21) and balanced accuracy by 5.85 points. Sixty-six participants improved on both endpoints. Improvements were also present at common-duration checkpoints and in a conventional spatial-filtering decoder.

The contribution complements existing domain-generalization algorithms by quantifying how source composition changes participant-level class coverage. The complete experiment comprises 108 neural trajectories and nine conventional fits. Code, full saved predictions, all protocol-specified contrasts and supplementary descriptive analyses are supplied. The external evaluation is identified as exploratory.

Previous interaction: an earlier version, PONE-D-26-50597, submitted on 9 October 2026, was rejected on 12 October 2026 because it was simultaneously under consideration elsewhere. I acknowledged this error and on 12 October asked whether a substantially revised version could be considered in future. This package is not presented as an invited revision or as an update to a manuscript still under review. Please confirm the appropriate route for considering this substantive extension. I understand and will comply with the requirement for exclusive consideration.

The manuscript includes the author-confirmed institutional exemption statement for secondary public-data research, provider attribution, data availability and disclosure of AI assistance. I suggest assignment to an Academic Editor with expertise in EEG decoding and reproducible machine learning; I have no opposed reviewers to declare.

Thank you for your guidance and consideration.

Sincerely,

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